Psoriasis

Recognizing a chronic condition and planning care with a clinician

ABOUT THIS TOPIC

Psoriasis is an immune-mediated condition that can cause raised, scaly, itchy or sore patches. It is not contagious. Appearance and severity vary, so a clinician should confirm the diagnosis, particularly for a first or unusual rash.

Everyday care and treatment

- Moisturizer can help dryness and scaling. Choose a fragrance-free product that feels comfortable to use regularly.
- Avoid picking scales or scratching, which can injure skin. Protect skin from sunburn and report new or changing spots.
- Treatment is tailored to the type, location, and extent of psoriasis. Options may include prescription topical medicines, light therapy, or medicines affecting the immune system.
- Do not start, stop, or share prescription treatment without discussing it with the treating clinician.

WHEN TO GET HELP

Ask for clinical review if patches are painful, cracking, spreading, affecting sensitive areas, or disrupting daily life. Tell a clinician about swollen, stiff, or painful joints, as psoriasis can be associated with joint disease.

Sources for further reading

American Academy of Dermatology - Psoriasis treatment - https://www.aad.org/public/diseases/psoriasis/treatment/treatment

American Academy of Dermatology - Psoriasis overview - https://www.aad.org/public/diseases/psoriasis/what/overview

Reviewed for this educational handout: October 2026. Recommendations can change and depend on local guidance, age, pregnancy, other health conditions, and medicines. This handout is not a diagnosis or prescription.